in 2020. In comparison, during the period 1992–2012, the revenue of the Tata Group rose nearly eighteen and a half times—from $5.43 billion to $100 billion, achieving a growth of nearly 1742 per cent. It exceeded that of GE by more than 1,360 percentage points, in dollar terms. If, however, the increase in revenue is mapped in terms of Indian rupees it would reveal an incredible rise of nearly 3,512 per cent (from 13.29 thousand crore in 1992 to 4.8 lakh crore in 2012).

Connecting the Centuries

Ratan will perhaps be most remembered for raising the Indian flag in the citadel of the Western industrial heartlands. The three large acquisitions—Tetley Tea, Corus and Jaguar Land Rover—and some others, made by Tata Chemicals for instance, were momentous for the Tata group and a lodestar for India. Most importantly, they became milestones in India's international presence in the first decade of the present century, the way the Taj Hotel, TISCO and Tata Electrical Companies, established in the first two decades of the previous century and the upshot of the founder Jamsetji Tata's vision, were national milestones.

Not many thought that the group would be able to expand abroad, striking at some of the bastions of Western pride. For Ratan, that was an irresistible challenge. And when he is challenged, he responds with his best. As he once said: 'The greatest pleasure I've had is to try to do something that people said would never be done.'

In 2004 he said, 'I hope that a hundred years from now we will spread our wings far beyond India, that we become a global group, operating in many countries, an Indian business conglomerate that is at home in the world, carrying the same sense of trust that we do today.' By 2008, Ratan had made a significant beginning. And consequently, the 2000s bore witness to the recognition of the Tatas as a global player. He hoisted the Tata name on the world map as a prominent and respected industrial conglomeration. The JLR acquisition was the most resplendent of all. It was an instance of a 'reversal of fortune: a once-proud civilization that became a colony' buying 'out the once-hallowed corporations of the West', wrote *The New York Times*. And before the curtain came down on the first decade of the new millennium the Tatas become the largest manufacturing employer